

SID HARTMAN

MINNESOTA hit .340 against Boston pitching in the three-game series that ended Thursday with a 7-2 Twins victory.

As a team, the Twins are hitting .235 after yesterday and may pass Oakland for the American League lead.

Ted Uhlaender hit .500 against Boston, followed by Rich Reese .467, Frank Quilici .400, Tony Oliva .385 and Cesar Tovar .364.

The Twins solved their scoring problems against Boston too. Having averaged 2.4 runs per game since May 26, the Twins scored 24 runs in winning two of three from the Red Sox—an eight-run average.

Injury Hurt: Tony Oliva hasn't stolen a base since June 6.

"I injured my right ankle early in June against Washington and I haven't been able to run well since," said the Twin outfielder, who has been thrown out in his only two attempts since June 6 and has 10 stolen bases for the year.

"The ankle doesn't give me any trouble when I'm hitting."

Twin pitchers note that they won the pennant in 1965 under pitching coach Johnny Sain, who doesn't believe in pitchers running a great deal. "Now Sain is operating under the same theory at Detroit and they are in first place," said a Twins pitcher who asked not to be named.

Jim Merritt adds: "I can't see how Mr. Griffith (Calvin, Twins president) can say we don't run enough after watching us just once."

Harmon Killebrew is no longer walking on crutches.

"I couldn't run or hit today but the leg has made real good improvement," said Harmon, who was injured in the All-Star game.



Rose Cuozzo Sain Oliva

Likes West: Andy Cohen, former Millers second baseman who took part in Tuesday night's Old Timers game, is the baseball coach at the University of Texas at El Paso, where the Vikings' second draft choice, Charley West, played baseball.

"I think I influenced West to try baseball rather than to sign a pro football contract right away," said Cohen. "West hit over .300 all three years he played for me. He not only was my best outfielder but also my best catcher."

"Personally, I don't feel West gave himself a chance to make it with Tampa (a Cincinnati farm team)."

"The Reds told West if he wanted to give baseball another try they would like the first chance to sign him again."

"We had some great athletes on our campus last year but West was our best."

Rose Here: Bert Rose, former Vikings general manager who left the New Orleans Saints last winter after a disagreement with the owners, says he is being paid off on a five-year contract.

"I haven't made a settlement," said Rose, who is visiting here.

Rose, who watched Gary Cuozzo perform for the Saints last fall, believes the Vikings obtained not only one of the finest passers in the NFL but a quarterback who is a "real brain."